

JobReady AI

PRODUCT DISCOVERY | Phase 1 — User Persona

Turning a life-ending moment into a life-changing phase — through right guidance, awareness and information.

1. WHO IS RAHUL

NAME Rahul	AGE 37 years old
LOCATION Hyderabad, India	FAMILY Married, one child (3 yrs), spouse works part-time
EXPERIENCE 11 years — IT Services & Product	CURRENT ROLE Senior Software Engineer (last role)
SITUATION Laid off — company-wide restructuring, 6 weeks ago	EDUCATION B.Tech (Tier 2 college)

*"I have eleven years of experience. I have shipped products used by thousands of people.
I should not be struggling like this. And yet — here I am."*

2. EMOTIONAL STATE — SNAPSHOT

Shame masked as busyness	Applies frantically to look productive. The activity is a shield against the fear of being seen as someone who failed.
Identity fracture	For 11 years, his job title was his identity. Without it, he does not know how to introduce himself. That fracture is quiet and devastating.
Paralysis by uncertainty	Does not know if the problem is his resume, skills, the ATS or the market. Cannot fix what he cannot diagnose. So he applies more — the only action that feels like control.

→ Full emotional & psychological deep-dive in Appendix A (Page 2)

3. BEHAVIOURAL PATTERNS — HOW RAHUL JOB SEARCHES

- Applies to 10–15 roles per week — quantity over quality, no customisation per JD
- Copy-pastes the same resume everywhere, makes minor edits, calls it 'tailoring'
- Checks email 30–40 times a day waiting for a response that rarely comes
- Spends time on LinkedIn scrolling — not networking with intent
- Has not done a mock interview in 6 weeks — avoids it because it surfaces gaps he is not ready to face
- Considers reaching out to old colleagues for referrals but doesn't — fears looking desperate

- Makes a to-do list every morning. By evening, only the easy items are done

4. GOALS & FEARS

GOALS	FEARS
• Land a Senior Engineer / Tech Lead role at or above last CTC within 60 days • Protect his family's financial stability and daily routine • Regain professional identity and self-worth • Eventually explore building something of his own if the right moment arrives	• Savings running out before an offer arrives • Being forced to accept a role significantly below his level • His child sensing that something is wrong at home • Skills becoming irrelevant while he is on the sidelines

5. WHAT RAHUL NEEDS FROM JOBREADY AI

SIGNAL, NOT NOISE	Tell him specifically why he is not getting responses — resume gap, skill mismatch, wrong role targeting. Not generic advice. Specific, actionable diagnosis.
DAILY STRUCTURED ACTION	Break the paralysis with three concrete actions he can complete today. Small wins that rebuild momentum and prevent the spiral into inertia.
PROFILE-MATCHED PREP	Interview questions for his specific experience level and the exact roles he is applying to — not generic lists from a 2019 blog post.
HONEST EMOTIONAL SUPPORT	He does not need false positivity. He needs a companion that acknowledges difficulty honestly and then redirects him toward action. Honesty with warmth.
VISIBILITY INTO THE SYSTEM	Help him understand ATS filtering, what hiring managers look for, what the market actually pays — the information asymmetry is what is defeating him.

**Rahul is not a weak person in a hard situation.
He is a capable professional in an *opaque* situation.
Give him the right information and he will find his way.**

Emotional & Psychological Deep-Dive

Supporting reference for product, copy and feature decisions

1. SHAME MASKED AS BUSYNESS

Rahul tells his family he is 'in talks' and 'interviewing next week'. He fills his calendar with applications to feel productive. The busyness is a shield. Beneath it is the fear that the people who depend on him might see him as someone who has failed. He has not failed — but that distinction is invisible to him right now.

2. IDENTITY FRACTURE

For 11 years, what Rahul does and who Rahul is have been the same thing. The job title, the company badge, the code he shipped — they were his identity. Without them, he does not know how to introduce himself at a dinner party. That fracture is quiet and devastating. It does not announce itself. It just makes everything feel slightly wrong.

3. ANXIETY DRESSED AS STRATEGY

He refreshes job portals at 11 PM. He applies to roles he is overqualified for and roles he is underqualified for in the same sitting. He calls it 'covering all bases'. It is anxiety making decisions, not strategy. He knows this. He cannot stop. The action of applying is the only thing that quiets the noise for a few minutes.

4. PARALYSIS BY UNCERTAINTY

He does not know if the problem is his resume, his skills, his seniority level, the ATS, the market, or a mismatch of expectations he was never told about. Without knowing what is broken, he cannot fix anything. So he fixes nothing and applies more — the only action that feels like control. This is the core loop JobReady AI must break.

5. SILENT GRIEF

No one at home fully understands. His spouse is supportive but anxious. He cannot fully unburden himself without adding to her worry. His friends are employed — their empathy has a ceiling. He carries most of this alone, in the space between midnight and 2 AM. This is where the Daily Momentum Generator matters most — someone (something) that acknowledges the weight without amplifying it.

6. FADING OPTIMISM

Week one: he was energised — this was a chance to reset. Week three: cautiously hopeful. Week six: quietly scared. He will not say he has lost hope — but he has started looking at options he would have dismissed three months ago. That shift tells its own story. The product must arrest this slide before it becomes permanent pessimism.

PRODUCT IMPLICATIONS

Tone of all copy

Honest, grounded, warm — never cheerful. Never 'You've got this!' Never dismissive of the weight.

Daily Momentum Generator	Must acknowledge the emotional state before assigning actions. 'It's week 6. That's hard. Here are 3 things for today.'
JD Analyser feedback	Frame gaps as fixable, time-bound actions — not verdicts. 'You're missing X — here's how to close it in 2 weeks.'
Mock Interview Engine	Must normalise stumbling. Failure in practice is the point — not a signal of permanent inadequacy.
Onboarding flow	First interaction must signal: this product understands your situation. Not just your resume.